

Word family: **bridge / bridges / bridged / bridging**

Base word: bridge

Plural noun: bridges

Verb forms: bridge / bridges / bridged / bridging

Related forms / useful compounds:

bridge (n.) — 橋；橋樑

bridge (v.) — 架橋；連接；縮小差距

bridging (n./adj.) — 連接；銜接

bridge-building (n./adj.) — 建立關係；促進合作

footbridge — 行人天橋 / 步行橋

suspension bridge — 吊橋

railway bridge — 鐵路橋

bridge of the nose — 鼻樑

dental bridge — 牙橋

bridge of a ship — 駕駛台

bridge in music — 橋段；過渡段

bridge on a guitar/violin — 琴橋

bridge (card game) — 橋牌

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Meaning in this passage

> A younger child accidentally broke a cardboard **bridge** he had spent a long time making.

Here, **bridge** means:

a structure that allows people, vehicles, etc. to cross over a river, road, gap, or other obstacle — 橋；橋樑

In Leo's case, it is a **model bridge made of cardboard**, rather than a full-sized real bridge.

中文翻譯：

一個年紀較小的孩子不小心弄壞了 Leo 花了很長時間製作的一座紙板**橋**。

So here:

bridge = 橋；連接兩邊、讓人或物跨越障礙的結構

1. **bridge** (橋 ; 橋樑) — 橋 ; 橋樑

This is the core literal meaning and the one used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> A younger child accidentally broke a cardboard **bridge**.

一個年紀較小的孩子不小心弄壞了一座紙板**橋**。

Practice 2

> We crossed the river by **bridge**.

我們從**橋上**過河。

Practice 3

> The old stone **bridge** has stood there for hundreds of years.

那座古老的石**橋**已經屹立了數百年。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge = 橫跨河流、道路、山谷或其他障礙，讓人或車輛通過的結構

2. **bridge over/across something** — 橫跨.....的橋

Practice 1

> They built a new **bridge across the river**.

他們在河上建了一座新**橋**。

Practice 2

> A narrow **bridge crosses the railway line**.

一座狹窄的**橋**橫跨鐵路。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge over/across something = 橫跨某個空間或障礙的橋樑

3. **footbridge** — 行人橋；行人天橋

Practice 1

> We crossed the road using the **footbridge**.

我們經**行人天橋**過馬路。

Practice 2

> A wooden **footbridge** connects the two sides of the park.

一座木製**步行橋**連接公園兩邊。

MCQ-ready definition:

footbridge = 主要供行人步行通過的小型橋樑

4. **suspension bridge** — 吊橋；懸索橋

Practice 1

> The city is famous for its enormous **suspension bridge**.

這座城市以巨大的**懸索橋**聞名。

Practice 2

> The hikers crossed a narrow **suspension bridge**.

行山人士走過一座狹窄的**吊橋**。

MCQ-ready definition:

suspension bridge = 橋面由鋼纜或懸索支撐的橋樑

5. **bridge** (連接兩者的東西) — 橋樑；連繫

This is the major figurative extension.

A person, idea, language, organization, etc. can be described as a **bridge** if it connects two otherwise separate groups or things.

Practice 1

> Music can be a **bridge between cultures**.

音樂可以成為不同文化之間的**橋樑**。

Practice 2

> She acted as a **bridge between the two departments**.

她成為兩個部門之間的**溝通橋樑**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge = 把兩個原本分開的人、群體、文化或概念連接起來的事物

6. **a bridge between A and B — A 與 B 之間的橋樑**

Practice 1

> Education can provide a **bridge between generations**.

教育可以成為不同世代之間的**橋樑**。

Practice 2

> The project created a **bridge between research and industry**.

這個項目在研究與產業之間建立了一道**橋樑**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a bridge between A and B = 促進兩者之間聯繫、理解或合作的媒介

7. **bridge the gap — 縮小 / 彌合差距**

One of the most important figurative verb expressions.

Practice 1

> The programme aims to **bridge the gap between rich and poor students**.

這個計劃旨在**縮小貧富學生之間的差距**。

Practice 2

> Technology can help **bridge the gap between distance and communication**.

科技可以幫助**彌合距離造成的溝通差距**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge the gap = 減少兩者之間的差異、距離或隔閡，使它們更接近

8. **bridge a divide — 彌合分歧；縮窄隔閡**

Practice 1

> The talks were intended to **bridge the political divide**.

會談旨在**彌合政治分歧**。

Practice 2

> Sport can sometimes **bridge social divides**.

運動有時可以**縮窄社會隔閡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge a divide = 減少群體、立場或社會之間的分歧和隔閡

9. **bridge a distance / difference — 跨越距離 / 消除差異**

Practice 1

> Video calls help **bridge long distances**.

視像通話有助**跨越遙遠距離**。

Practice 2

> Shared experiences can **bridge differences in background**.

共同經歷可以**縮窄背景上的差異**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge = 克服兩者之間的距離、差異或障礙

10. **bridge two things** — 連接兩者；把兩方面結合

Practice 1

> The course **bridges theory and practice**.

這門課把理論與實踐**連接起來**。

Practice 2

> Her work **bridges art and technology**.

她的作品把藝術與科技**結合起來**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge two things = 把兩個原本分開或不同的領域、概念或活動連接起來

11. **bridge a period / transition** — 銜接一段時期；填補過渡期

Practice 1

> The temporary job helped **bridge the period between graduation and full-time employment**.

那份臨時工作幫助他**銜接畢業與全職工作之間的過渡期**。

Practice 2

> The loan was intended to **bridge a short-term funding gap**.

這筆貸款旨在**填補短期資金缺口**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge a period/gap = 暫時填補兩個階段之間的空缺，使過渡順利

12. **bridge-building** — 建立關係；促進合作

A figurative noun/adjective.

Practice 1

> The meeting focused on **bridge-building** between the two groups.

會議重點是促進兩個群體之間的**關係建立與合作**。

Practice 2

> She is known for her **bridge-building efforts**.

她以積極**建立各方關係**而聞名。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge-building = 主動改善不同群體之間的關係、理解或合作

13. **build bridges** — 建立關係；化解隔閡

A very common figurative expression.

Practice 1

> The event was designed to **build bridges** between local communities.

這項活動旨在**促進不同本地社群之間的關係**。

Practice 2

> Good communication can **build bridges** between people with different views.

良好溝通可以在持不同觀點的人之間**建立理解與聯繫**。

MCQ-ready definition:

build bridges = 建立互信、聯繫和理解，尤其在原本有分歧的人或群體之間

14. **burn your bridges** — 斷絕後路；破壞關係至難以回頭

A common idiom.

Practice 1

> Don't **burn your bridges** when you leave your job.

離職時不要**把關係徹底破壞**，令自己沒有回頭路。

Practice 2

> He criticized everyone publicly and **burned his bridges** with the team.

他公開批評所有人，結果與團隊**徹底鬧翻**。

MCQ-ready definition:

burn your bridges = 做出令自己難以返回原來處境、或令重要關係無法修復的事

15. **cross that bridge when we come to it** — 到時再處理

A very common idiom.

Practice 1

> We may have problems later, but we'll **cross that bridge when we come to it**.

之後可能有問題，但我們**到時再處理吧**。

Practice 2

> Don't worry about next year's costs yet—we'll **cross that bridge when we come to it**.

暫時不用擔心明年的成本，**到時再算吧**。

MCQ-ready definition:

cross that bridge when we come to it = 問題真正出現時才處理，不必現在提前擔心

16. **water under the bridge** — 已經過去、不值得再介懷的事

Practice 1

> We argued years ago, but that's all **water under the bridge** now.

我們幾年前吵過架，但那些事現在都**已經過去了**。

Practice 2

> Let's forget what happened; it's **water under the bridge**.

忘掉以前發生的事吧，那些都**已成過去**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****water under the bridge = 已經發生並成為過去、不值得再爭論或介懷的事情****

17. ****bridge of the nose — 鼻樑****

A genuine anatomical sense.

Practice 1

> The glasses were resting on the ****bridge of his nose****.

眼鏡架在他的****鼻樑****上。

Practice 2

> She had a small cut on the ****bridge of her nose****.

她的****鼻樑****上有一道小傷口。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****bridge of the nose = 鼻子上部、兩眼之間較突出的部分，即鼻樑****

18. ****dental bridge — 牙橋；固定式假牙橋****

A dental use.

Practice 1

> The dentist recommended a ****dental bridge**** to replace the missing tooth.

牙醫建議使用****牙橋****來補回缺失的牙齒。

Practice 2

> Her ****bridge**** needs to be replaced.

她的****牙橋****需要更換。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****dental bridge = 用鄰近牙齒作支撐，用來填補缺牙位置的固定式牙科裝置****

19. **bridge of a ship** — 船橋；駕駛台

A maritime sense.

Practice 1

> The captain returned to the **bridge**.

船長返回**駕駛台**。

Practice 2

> Officers on the **bridge** were monitoring the weather.

船橋 / 駕駛台上的人員正在監察天氣。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge = 船上負責導航、操控和指揮航行的區域，即**駕駛台**

20. **bridge (music)** — 橋段；過渡段

In music, a **bridge** is a section that connects major parts of a song and often contrasts with them.

Practice 1

> The song has a beautiful **bridge** before the final chorus.

這首歌在最後副歌前有一段很美的**橋段 / 過渡段**。

Practice 2

> The **bridge** changes the mood of the song.

那段**橋段**改變了歌曲的氣氛。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge = 歌曲中連接主要段落、通常帶來旋律或和聲變化的過渡部分

21. **bridge (樂器)** — 琴橋；琴碼

On stringed instruments such as guitars and violins.

Practice 1

> The guitar's **bridge** needs repairing.

那把結他的**琴橋**需要修理。

Practice 2

> The violin strings rest on the **bridge**.

小提琴的弦架在**琴橋**上。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge = 弦樂器上支撐琴弦、並把震動傳到琴身的部件

22. **bridge (橋牌) — 橋牌**

This is actually a **homonym** rather than a semantic extension from physical bridges.

Practice 1

> My grandparents play **bridge** every Friday.

我的祖父母每個星期五都打**橋牌**。

Practice 2

> She learned to play **bridge** at university.

她在大學時學會玩**橋牌**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge = 一種由四名玩家參與的紙牌遊戲，即橋牌

Important note

This meaning should be kept separate from:

> **bridge = 橋**

They share the same spelling and pronunciation in modern English, but the card-game meaning is

not usefully understood as a metaphorical extension of a physical bridge.

23. **bridge loan / bridging loan** — 過渡貸款；短期過橋貸款

A finance/property term, useful but domain-specific.

Practice 1

> They used a **bridging loan** while waiting for their old house to be sold.

他們等候舊屋出售期間使用了一筆**過渡貸款**。

Practice 2

> A **bridge loan** can provide short-term financing.

過橋貸款可以提供短期融資。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridge/bridging loan = 在較長期資金到位前，用來暫時填補資金缺口的短期貸款

24. **bridging course / programme** — 銜接課程

Common in education.

Practice 1

> She took a **bridging course** before starting university.

她入大學前修讀了一個**銜接課程**。

Practice 2

> The programme helps students **bridge the gap** between school and university.

這個課程幫助學生**銜接中學與大學之間的過渡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bridging course/programme = 幫助學生由一個學習階段順利過渡到另一階段的課程

Important distinction 1: **bridge vs tunnel**

bridge

passes **over** an obstacle.

tunnel

passes **through or under** an obstacle.

> a **bridge over the river**

> 河上的橋

> a **tunnel under the river**

> 河底隧道

Important distinction 2: **bridge vs overpass**

bridge

broad word for a structure crossing an obstacle.

overpass

especially a road/bridge that passes over another road or railway.

So every overpass is broadly a type of bridge, but not every bridge is an overpass.

Important distinction 3: **bridge vs footbridge**

bridge

general category.

footbridge

specifically intended mainly for pedestrians.

> a road **bridge**

> 行車橋

> a **footbridge**

> 行人橋

Important distinction 4: **bridge the gap vs close the gap**

These are very close.

bridge the gap

emphasizes **creating a connection across the separation**.

close the gap

emphasizes **reducing the size of the difference**.

> Education can **bridge the gap** between generations.

教育可以促進世代之間的連接和理解。

> The company wants to **close the pay gap**.

公司希望縮小薪酬差距。

Important distinction 5: **bridge vs connect**

connect

very broad.

> The road **connects** the two towns.

這條路連接兩個城鎮。

bridge

often implies there is some **gap, divide, obstacle, or separation** to overcome.

> The programme **bridges** the gap between theory and practice.

這個課程**彌合理論與實踐之間的差距**。

So **bridge** contains a stronger metaphor of overcoming separation.

Important distinction 6: **bridge vs link**

link

simply establishes a connection.

bridge

often emphasizes connecting things that were significantly separated.

> The railway **links** the two cities.

鐵路連接兩座城市。

> The initiative **bridges** cultural differences.

這項計劃彌合文化差異。

Important distinction 7: **bridge the gap vs fill the gap**

bridge the gap

connect the two sides / reduce separation.

fill the gap

supply something missing.

> Training can **bridge the skills gap**.

培訓可以縮小技能差距。

> Temporary staff can **fill the gap**.

臨時員工可以填補人手空缺。

Important distinction 8: **build bridges vs bridge the gap**

build bridges

usually emphasizes **relationships, goodwill, communication**.

> We need to **build bridges** between the communities.

我們需要改善兩個社群之間的關係。

bridge the gap

usually emphasizes **reducing a specific difference or separation**.

> We need to **bridge the gap** in educational achievement.

我們需要縮小教育成績差距。

Important distinction 9: **burn your bridges vs break ties**

break ties

= end a relationship or connection.

burn your bridges

= end it in such a way that returning becomes difficult or impossible.

So **burn your bridges** is stronger and more vivid.

Important distinction 10: **bridge (structure) vs bridge (ship)**

Structure

> cross the **bridge**

過橋

Ship

> the captain is on the **bridge**

船長在駕駛台。

These are genuinely distinct lexical senses despite sharing the same word.

Important distinction 11: **bridge (music) vs chorus**

chorus

the repeated central section of many songs.

bridge

usually appears less often and provides contrast or transition.

So:

verse → chorus → bridge → chorus

is a common song structure.

Important distinction 12: **bridge (card game) vs bridge (structure)**

These should be kept completely separate in meaning.

a bridge

橋

bridge

橋牌

Notice also the grammar:

> cross **a bridge**

but:

> play **bridge**

The card game is normally uncountable as the name of the game.

Family-extension note

Bridge is an excellent polysemy candidate because it contains a very clear central physical image:

a structure connecting two separated sides

That image extends productively into abstract language:

a bridge between cultures
bridge the gap
bridge differences
build bridges
bridging course
bridge loan

These should be grouped around the common idea of **connection across a separation**.

But other senses are more lexicalized and should be kept distinct:

bridge of the nose
dental bridge
ship's bridge
musical bridge
instrument bridge
bridge the card game

The card-game meaning in particular is best treated as a **homonym**, not as another metaphorical branch of the physical bridge.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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bridge (structure)	橋；橋樑	cross an obstacle	
bridge across/over X	橫跨 X 的橋	physical crossing	
footbridge	行人橋	pedestrian bridge	
suspension bridge	吊橋 / 懸索橋	bridge type	
a bridge between A and B	A 與 B 之間的橋樑	figurative connection	
bridge the gap	縮小 / 彌合差距	reduce separation	
bridge a divide	彌合分歧	overcome division	
bridge differences	縮窄差異	connect differences	
bridge theory and practice	連接理論與實踐	combine domains	
build bridges	建立關係	promote understanding	
bridge-building	建立關係 / 合作	reconciliation	
burn your bridges	斷絕後路	destroy possibility of return	

cross that bridge when we come to it	到時再處理	deal with future problem later	
water under the bridge	已成過去的事	no longer worth worrying about	
bridge of the nose	鼻樑	anatomical structure	
dental bridge	牙橋	dental appliance	
ship's bridge	船橋；駕駛台	navigation/control area	
bridge (music)	橋段；過渡段	connects musical sections	
bridge (instrument)	琴橋	supports strings	
bridge (card game)	橋牌	separate homonym	
bridge/bridging loan	過橋貸款	temporary finance	
bridging course	銜接課程	transitional study	

For your original sentence

> A younger child accidentally broke a cardboard **bridge** he had spent a long time making.

Here:

bridge = 橋；橋樑

More precisely, it is:

a model bridge made of cardboard — 用紙板製作的模型橋

The sentence uses the **literal physical-structure sense**.

The semantic image behind many later uses is:

physical bridge joins two separated sides

→ **figurative bridge joins two separated people, groups, ideas, or stages**

But in your passage, no metaphor is intended at all. Leo had literally built a small **cardboard bridge**, and another child accidentally damaged it.